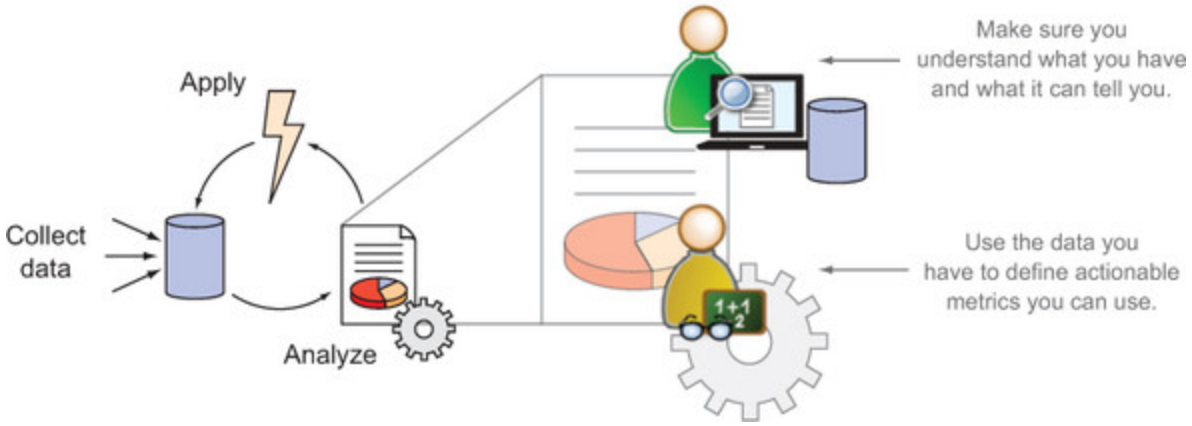
Figure 7.1 shows these steps in the context of the big picture.

Figure 7.1. Building metrics in the context of collecting, analyzing, and applying metrics



In the analysis phase you want to spend enough time understanding what data you have and how it's connected so that you can define actionable metrics that become useful in your development cycle.

As you've seen throughout this book, there's so much data generated throughout the application lifecycle that no one or even two data points can give you a clear indicator of performance for your team. To get the best picture in previous chapters, we looked at data points from different systems alone or next to one another. An alternative to that technique is to combine these elements into metrics that shed light on larger questions that can't be answered by a single data point.

An example of a calculated metric that we've already looked at is recidivism. Recidivism tells you how frequently your team is moving the wrong way in your workflow. It's calculated purely with PTS data with the following formula:

```
Recidivism = bN / (fN + bN)
```

- `N` = number of tasks
- `f` = moving forward in the workflow
- `b` = moving backward in the workflow